■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Sunday, July 12, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (3 stories)

■■ *Apple sues OpenAI over stolen trade secrets and talent drain*

The Angle: *Apple's alleging OpenAI employees made off with confidential tech info as the AI lab gears up for its first hardware launch. It's the latest salvo in an escalating tech industry turf war over AI dominance and insider poaching.*

- **Apple** filed suit against **OpenAI**, claiming employees wrongfully took **secret and confidential information** about unreleased technology
- The lawsuit comes as **OpenAI prepares to unveil its first hardware device**
- **Apple has lost significant talent** to OpenAI as the frontier lab scales up

The Tech Conflict

- Is this just corporate saber-rattling, or is OpenAI genuinely playing dirty in the talent wars?

Axios (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.axios.com/2026/07/10/apple-sues-openai-trade-secret-theft

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■ *Canada's 'energy sovereignty' plan amid Trump tariff threats*

The Angle: *As Trump flexes tariffs and annexation talk, Canadian leaders are suddenly fixated on 'energy sovereignty'—but nobody can quite agree what it means. Here's the tension between what the Carney government wants and what's actually working elsewhere.*

- **Donald Trump** returned to office with **punishing tariffs** and talk of Canada as **'the 51st state'**
- Canada's leaders began invoking **'energy sovereignty'** as a response to U.S. pressure
- The **Carney government's** interpretation of energy sovereignty **appears out of step with other countries'** approaches

The Definition Debate

- If Canada's own government can't clearly define what 'energy sovereignty' actually means, how is it supposed to protect us from Trump's threats?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: What Does It Actually Mean?** - First 90 seconds -> Hosts parse the phrase together: What does 'energy sovereignty' even look like on the ground—domestic oil production, supply independence, price control, something else? Call out the vagueness.
- **Step 2: How Are Other Countries Doing It?** - Next beat -> Hosts compare Canada's approach to what's working in other nations—highlight the gap between Carney's vision and real-world examples from Europe, Australia, or the U.S.
- **Step 3: Does It Actually Stop Trump?** - Close-out -> Reality check: Can energy policy really shield Canada from tariffs and trade war rhetoric, or is this messaging to calm voters?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/business/canada-energy-sovereignty-oil-climate-9.7265441?cmp=rss

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■ *Study: Women with brain injuries bypassed for specialized care*

The Angle: *A new Canadian study reveals a troubling gender gap in emergency care—women with traumatic brain injuries are getting sent to regular hospitals instead of specialized trauma centres at rates significantly higher than men. It's the kind of hidden bias in healthcare that could literally be life-altering.*

- **Canadian study** found women with traumatic brain injuries **significantly less likely** than men to be admitted to **specialized trauma centres**
- Women are being routed to general hospitals instead of facilities equipped to handle complex brain trauma
- Traumatic brain injuries can have severe long-term consequences if not treated at the right level of care

The Hidden Bias Question

- Have you or someone you know been steered to the wrong hospital in an emergency—and did gender play a role you didn't realize until later?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/health/why-women-with-brain-injuries-may-not-be-getting-to-the-right-hospital

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TRENDING TODAY

■ *Canadians are swapping homes instead of paying hotel bills*

The Angle: *With travel costs hitting record highs, home exchanges are exploding across Canada as a legitimate way to vacation for almost nothing. It's a trend reshaping how people actually afford to get away.*

- **Home exchange networks** report a **massive surge in Canadian members**
- Rising accommodation costs are pushing travelers to swap houses instead of booking hotels
- The shift reflects Canadians actively rethinking vacation spending as travel budgets get squeezed

The Trust Barrier

- Would you actually let a stranger live in your house for a week to save a few hundred bucks on vacation?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Gut Check** - Quick poll -> Ask listeners: Have you ever done a home exchange, or would you? What's the biggest hesitation—trust, logistics, or something else?
- **Step 2: The Trade-Off** - Host debate -> One host plays the skeptic (security risks, what if they break stuff), the other sells the savings angle. Which side wins?
- **Step 3: The Confession Line** - Phone segment -> Open lines: Have you swapped homes? Tell us the story—best-case or disaster scenario.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/home-exchanges-travel-popularity-9.7250411?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *Grey whales are dying along our shores. Researchers say a warming climate may be part of the problem*

The Angle: *Grey whales are dying along our shores. Researchers say a warming climate may be part of the problem*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/radio/whatonearth/grey-whales-under-threat-9.7261423?cmp=rss

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LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Gym Supplement Creatine Might Help Battle Depression*

The Angle: *A new analysis of existing research suggests creatine monohydrate—a cheap, common workout powder—could have real benefits for mental health and depression symptoms. It's the kind of surprising wellness crossover that's getting people talking.*

- Researchers analyzed data from **five randomized controlled trials** already in the literature

- The focus: how **creatine monohydrate** intake affects **mental health**
- Creatine is already a **popular and affordable gym supplement** used by millions for muscle building

The Brain vs. Brawn Question

- If creatine actually works for depression, does that change whether you'd take it—or recommend it to someone struggling?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Host A's Honest Take** - 30 seconds -> Host A admits whether they've ever used creatine or taken supplements for mental health—sets the real-world tone
- **Step 2: Host B Plays Skeptic** - 45 seconds -> Host B pushes back: Is this one study? Are people gonna overdose on gym powder thinking it's therapy? What are the actual risks?
- **Step 3: The Caller Question** - Open phones -> Ask listeners: Have YOU noticed a mood shift from any supplement—or is this snake oil? Real stories only.

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/health/popular-workout-supplement-could-with-depression-many-moving-parts

Backup options:

■ *Britney Spears explains freeway freakout: 'Nothing is what it seems'*

The Angle: *Britney's back in the spotlight for some wild public behavior on an LA freeway—and she's firing back at the narrative. It's the latest chapter in her ongoing relationship with tabloid scrutiny and how she's choosing to control her own story now.*

- **Britney Spears** drew attention after putting on a show in LA traffic
- The incident happened just months after her **DUI arrest**
- She's now defending herself with the statement **'Nothing is what it seems'**

The Read-Between-The-Lines

- When a major celebrity says 'nothing is what it seems' after a public incident, are we reading too much into her behavior—or not enough?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/07/11/celebrity-news/britney-spears-defends-wild-behavior-in-la-traffic-nothing-is-what-it-seems/

■ *Precautions to take as cyclosporiasis cases in Michigan exceed 1,500 - ClickOnDetroit | WDIV Local 4*

The Angle: *Precautions to take as cyclosporiasis cases in Michigan exceed 1,500 - ClickOnDetroit | WDIV Local 4*

WDIV ClickOnDetroit (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.clickondetroit.com/news/local/2026/07/11/precautions-to-take-as-cyclosporiasis-cases-in-michigan-exceed-1500/

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *Your bathroom mirror just became a party starter*

The Angle: *Lifx just dropped a smart mirror that doubles as programmable party lighting—and it's the kind of gadget that makes you wonder if we've officially turned every room in the house into a connected device. It's fun, it's weird, and it's probably a sign of where home tech is heading.*

- **Lifx** launched a smart mirror with **programmable party lighting** built into the frame
- The device is currently **one-of-a-kind on the market**, with no direct competitors yet
- It's the kind of gadget that blurs the line between **bathroom essential** and **tech novelty**

The Stuff You Never Knew You Needed

- Would you actually buy a light-up party mirror for your bathroom, or is this where smart home innovation officially jumped the shark?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN
- **Step 1: The Poll** - Quick fire (1 min) -> Ask listeners: bathroom essential or pure novelty? Get fast social/text votes on whether they'd spend money on this.
- **Step 2: The Pitch Battle** - Host debate (2 min) -> One host argues the practical angle (great lighting, smart home integration), the other leans into the absurdity (a party mirror? really?). Trade barbs.
- **Step 3: The Confession** - Open phones (3 min) -> Invite listeners to call in with the dumbest or most brilliant smart home gadget they've actually bought. Keep it light and funny.

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/you-know-what-your-bathroom-needs-party-lighting-2000781221

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/3 this month; TECH TALK 2/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *Assassin's Creed Black Flag was a great pirate game in 2013. Is it worth playing again in this remake?*

The Angle: *Assassin's Creed Black Flag was a great pirate game in 2013. Is it worth playing again in this remake?*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/assassins-creed-black-flag-resynced-remake-9.7264166?cmp=rss

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■ *Battery trucks are beating hydrogen in the real world*

The Angle: *For years, the energy industry bet big on hydrogen as the future of heavy trucking. But battery-electric is actually winning the race—and that shift is reshaping how companies are investing billions in green transport.*

- **Hydrogen** has long been promoted as the solution for electrifying heavy long-haul trucks and reducing emissions
- **Battery-electric trucks** are now outpacing hydrogen in real-world adoption and market momentum
- The shift challenges years of industry assumptions about which technology would dominate decarbonized trucking

The Surprise Win
- Did you think hydrogen was going to be the future? Turns out the underdog technology might have just won.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/science/hydrogen-battery-electric-trucks-9.7266083?cmp=rss

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■ *Argentina outlasts Switzerland in epic World Cup quarterfinal thriller*

The Angle: *Argentina advances to the World Cup semifinals after a dramatic 3-1 victory in extra time, keeping Messi's bid for a second title alive—though his personal scoring streak hits a wall. This is a knockout-round shocker that reshapes the tournament's final four.*

- **Álvarez** scored in the **112th minute** to break a 1-1 tie and propel Argentina past Switzerland
- Final score: **Argentina 3, Switzerland 1**
- **Messi's** nine-game World Cup scoring streak ended in this match

- Argentina advances to the **World Cup semifinal** and remains in contention for a **second World Cup title**

The Debate Starter

- Is Messi's individual scoring streak ending a real dent in his legacy run, or does getting out of a tight quarterfinal the hard way actually prove Argentina's the team to beat?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/sports/soccer/worldcup/fifa-world-cup-recap-argentina-switzerland-quarterfinal-july-11-9.7266897?cmp=rss

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■ *Conor McGregor suffers early knee injury in return, loses to Max Holloway at UFC 329*

The Angle: *Conor McGregor suffers early knee injury in return, loses to Max Holloway at UFC 329*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/sports/conor-mcgregor-ufc-329-injury-9.7267266?cmp=rss

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■ *B.C. drowning deaths rise sharply as safety groups urge life-jacket use*

The Angle: *B.C. drowning deaths rise sharply as safety groups urge life-jacket use*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/drowning-deaths-in-b-c-9.7267193?cmp=rss

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■ *U.S.-Iran strikes ratchet up tensions as Tehran says Hormuz is shut*

The Angle: *U.S.-Iran strikes ratchet up tensions as Tehran says Hormuz is shut*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/news/world/u-s-iran-strikes-ratchet-up-tensions-as-tehran-says-hormuz-is-shut

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■ *Must-see TV: Anya Taylor-Joy's 'Lucky' tops this week's watch list*

The Angle: *Must-see TV: Anya Taylor-Joy's 'Lucky' tops this week's watch list*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/entertainment/television/must-see-tv-anya-taylor-joys-lucky-tops-this-weeks-watch-list

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■ *Never mind socialism — the rebellious kids are all conservative and love America*

The Angle: *Never mind socialism — the rebellious kids are all conservative and love America*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/12/opinion/loving-america-is-the-most-rebellious-thing-kids-can-do/

■ *Is 'Landman' Airing a New Episode Tonight? Everything We Know About 'Landman' Season 3*

The Angle: *Is 'Landman' Airing a New Episode Tonight? Everything We Know About 'Landman' Season 3*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/07/12/landman-new-episode-tonight-paramount-plus-what-we-know-landman-season-3-return/

■ *Dodgers draft high-potential Bo Lowrance, Dino Ebel gets family surprise*

The Angle: *Dodgers draft high-potential Bo Lowrance, Dino Ebel gets family surprise*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/12/sports/dodgers-take-bo-lowrance-in-second-round-of-mlb-draft/

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *Meta kills AI photo tool after massive public backlash*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Public backlash forcing Meta to scrap an AI tool taps into the exact moment of peak AI skepticism and regulatory tension - this has clear trend alignment with ongoing AI safety discourse.
The Angle: *Meta just yanked a new AI feature before it barely launched—a rare win for consumer pushback against Big Tech. This is one of those moments where enough people saying 'absolutely not' actually forced a company to reverse course.*

- **Meta** scrapped a new AI photo tool after **public outcry** and negative reaction forced the decision
- The backlash was significant enough that the company chose to kill the feature rather than defend or modify it
- This represents a rare instance of **public pressure actually working** against a major tech company's product rollout

The Win Counter

- When was the last time you actually saw Big Tech back down from something because users said no—and did it feel as surprising as it should?

X/Twitter @Gizmodo (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Gizmodo/status/2076123526927437881

■ *Another Safety Chief Walks Out at OpenAI*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Another safety leader departing OpenAI during a period of intense internal conflict signals a major institutional story with legs that typically gains momentum as more reporting follows.
The Angle: *OpenAI's losing key voices on AI safety—the third major departure in months. As the company races to build more powerful AI, the people hired to pump the brakes keep heading for the exits, raising questions about whether safety is actually a priority.*

- **Another senior safety leader has departed OpenAI**, continuing a pattern of exits from the company's safety and policy teams
- This is at least the **third major safety-focused departure in recent months**
- The departures come as **OpenAI accelerates development of more powerful AI models** and expands its commercial footprint

The Red Flag Question

- When the safety experts keep bailing on an AI company, what does that tell you about what's really going on behind closed doors?

X/Twitter @Gizmodo (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Gizmodo/status/2076061241831727325

■ *Meta's AI detector fails at its own game*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Meta's AI detector failing on its own generated images is a perfect encapsulation of AI hype meeting reality - inherently shareable contradiction with policy implications.
The Angle: *Meta rolled out tools to catch AI-generated images, but a new report shows the detector can't even identify pictures it created itself. It's a major credibility hit for a company betting big on AI safety—and raises real questions about whether these detection tools actually work at scale.*

- **Meta** launched an AI image detector designed to flag AI-generated content
- The detector **failed to identify images that Meta's own AI systems generated**
- The finding comes from a new report highlighting fundamental weaknesses in detection technology
- The flaw undermines Meta's claims about controlling synthetic media on its platforms

The Trust Buster

- If Meta can't spot its own AI images, how are *we* supposed to know what's real anymore—and should we even trust these platforms to police themselves?

X/Twitter @Gizmodo (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Gizmodo/status/2076056377621979215

■ *Box Office: 'Moana' Flounders With $43 Million Debut, Among Weakest of Disney's Live-Action Remakes https://t.co/5kpnePhX7W*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Disney's live-action 'Moana' underperforming signals a potential turning point in the franchise strategy that could spark broader reckoning coverage about Hollywood's remake saturation.
The Angle: *Box Office: 'Moana' Flounders With $43 Million Debut, Among Weakest of Disney's Live-Action Remakes https://t.co/5kpnePhX7W*

X/Twitter @Variety (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Variety/status/2076321249630851422

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 2 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Meta Begins Data Center Invasion of Canada, Which Reminds Me of Some Weird Zuck Trivia" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-09)
- "Lake Tahoe home invaded by creepy squatter as bizarre details emerge" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-11)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 16 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Wes Anderson Was Trapped in Academy Museum Elevator After ‘Bottle Rocket’ Anniversary Event" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-08)
- "‘Rent’ West End Revival Reveals Cast Joining Gaten Matarazzo: Travis Ross as Roger, Bella Brown as Mimi and More" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-08)
- "The #Rent musical revival in London's West End has announced its cast:" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-08)
- "JENNIE and Rosalía L.O.L. Surprise! O.M.G Dolls: 10th Anniversary Collectibles" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-08)
- "Gen Z Leans Hard into Nostalgia to Spur Music and Content Discovery: Study" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Nike Releases New Limited-Edition Air Jordan 7 Retro ‘Miró’ Sneakers: Here’s Where To Buy a Pair Online" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Thousands of ‘Pokémon Go’ Players Descend on Times Square to Defeat Mewtwo - WIRED" (Wired (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-10)
- "Jay-Z opens his ‘Reasonable Doubt’ 30th anniversary show at Yankee Stadium by bringing out Beyoncé for “Can’t Knock the Hustle.” https://t.c" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Jay-Z opens his ‘Reasonable Doubt’ 30th anniversary show at Yankee Stadium by brining out Beyoncé for “Can’t Knock the Hustle.” https://t.co" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Jay-Z Brings Out Beyoncé, Blue Ivy Carter, Nas, Alicia Keys and More for ‘Reasonable Doubt’ 30th Anniversary Show at Yankee Stadium" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Jay-Z Brings Out Beyoncé, Blue Ivy Carter, Nas, Alicia Keys and More for 'Reasonable Doubt' 30th Anniversary Show at Yankee Stadium https://" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Karlovy Vary Film Fest Awards Go to ‘Fruit Gathering,’ ‘The Guest,’ ‘Lover, Not a Fighter’ and ‘Incinerator’" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Hilary Duff Delights With Equal Parts Nostalgia and Evolution on The Lucky Me Tour: “Joyful, Fun and Extremely Rewarding”" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Jay-Z Celebrates ‘The Blueprint’ 25th Anniversary With Eminem, Pharrell Williams and Slick Rick at Yankee Stadium" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Eagle-eyed fans spot haunting detail in ‘RHOA’ Cynthia Bailey’s photo" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Jay-Z Celebrates 'The Blueprint' 25th Anniversary With Eminem, Pharrell Williams and Slick Rick at Yankee Stadium https://t.co/tUvxpPLa9c" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-12)

Newly banked this run:
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Jay-Z Celebrates ‘The Blueprint’ 25th Anniversary With Eminem, Pharrell Williams and Slick Rick at Yankee Stadium"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Eagle-eyed fans spot haunting detail in ‘RHOA’ Cynthia Bailey’s photo"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Karlovy Vary Film Fest Awards Go to ‘Fruit Gathering,’ ‘The Guest,’ ‘Lover, Not a Fighter’ and ‘Incinerator’"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Jay-Z Celebrates 'The Blueprint' 25th Anniversary With Eminem, Pharrell Williams and Slick Rick at Yankee Stadium https://t.co/tUvxpPLa9c"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Hilary Duff Delights With Equal Parts Nostalgia and Evolution on The Lucky Me Tour: “Joyful, Fun and Extremely Rewarding”"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- www.ctvnews.ca (Google News proxy fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 100+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- 12 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-07-12 01:10 PM